

I completed every task that I could think up to help me prepare for the test. I borrowed the complete CCNA course in book form from the teacher. I read over it and reviewed as much as I could while reading ahead in the book over the things that had not been covered yet, granted it was not that much. The teacher also sat down with me to review questions that might appear on the test and what the correct answers would be. He provided me with a computer program that would generate test questions. Despite the fact that the test at the competition was only going to be multiple choice, the test generator supplied multiple choice, matching, and simulations. These features helped me immensely in gaining an edge over my competition. The last major key that helped me prepare was doing the Cisco labs. The labs would have a scenario built and the person doing the lab would have to physically set up equipment, program the correct commands into the equipment, and test the results. All of these factors helped me to gain an edge in the competition.

When the awards ceremony began, the group was excited. We were all hoping that we placed in our events. Before my competition's awards were called out, two of my friends' competitions had been called, and they both had placed in the top ten. I knew that if they had placed, then so had I. As the announcer began rattling off the names of the top ten individuals that had placed, I became very nervous. As the announcer went on, I counted on my hands how many names were left. As each finger came up, I was more nervous. When my tenth finger rose, and my name was not called, I knew that I had blew it. I had not placed in the top ten in Cisco Systems Administration. I felt I had let myself down. I began to tell myself that I did not work hard enough or did not study enough. I had let my school down. Though I had been confident in my knowledge of the material, I underestimated the other competitors.